Kitten

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General Audiences

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

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Additional Tags:
Jealous Adora (She-Ra), Lesbian Adora (She-Ra), Lesbian Catra (She-Ra), Trans Adora (She-Ra), Melog (She-Ra) - Freeform, jealousy fic, Protective Adora (She-Ra)

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Part 1 of Fiercely Loyal

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by Jingujiwa

Summary

Adora considers herself a reasonable person.

At least, she considers herself someone who's trying to be a reasonable person. Because right now this might just be one of the most difficult challenges she's faced, and she's had her fair share of those. Egocentric warlords, abusive mother figures, losing the people closest to her (repeatedly), an even bigger galactic warlord- she's fought that and won. But some girl eyeing Catra right across from her in a busy market?

That's new.

And she doesn't know how to handle that.

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

Chapter 1

Adora considers herself a reasonable person.

At least, she considers herself someone who's *trying* to be a reasonable person. Because right now this might just be one of the most difficult challenges she's faced, and she's had her fair share of those. Egocentric warlords, abusive mother figures, losing the people closest to her (repeatedly), an even *bigger* galactic warlord- she's fought that and *won.* But some girl eyeing Catra right across from her in the middle of a busy market?

That's new.

And she doesn't know how to handle that.

The girl in question, she guesses, is pretty. And that might just be what adds to the burning fire building in her chest. She's bulkier than Adora, around a foot or so taller with arms twice the size of hers and she's staring at Catra across the plaza with an enamored look on her face while she twirls her long amber hair around her fingers. Adora knows Catra. She knows *what* she likes. Adora can’t say Catra hasn’t had her fair share of unwarranted suitors throughout her life. She knows that’s not true- because *look* at her. It’s just that no one has been so bold as to do it in front of her.

Adora feels her eyes narrow in on the woman even more. She can't help it, alright?

This random stranger is being so obvious with her actions, projecting their attraction towards *her* girlfriend like the entirety of Etheria doesn't already know who Catra belon-- Stop it, Adora. Not now. Now's not the time to let these ugly thoughts fester. Think about what Bow would say to you, what would he tell you to do right now? Bow always knows what to say. He would say to stop and breathe- think about what you're going to do before you do it. Before you *regret* it.

Adora stands straight and squares her shoulders, the pastries she was hunched over and surveying quickly forgotten.

In. Out.

Breathe.

Adora exhales and turns fully across the plaza to face her girlfriend. If the breathing exercise didn't help, seeing her stunning, gorgeous, heart-stopping girlfriend definitely does. She is still at the stall Adora had left her at when she b-lined for the pastries, leaned over, and thoughtfully inspecting the wide range of daggers before her. Her voluminous brown hair, now after years of uninterrupted growth, is pulled behind her narrow shoulders in a loose fishtail braid, bangs peeking out and framing her face along with her lovely dual eyes. She must have felt Adora's eyes on her because soon enough she's also turning to her, waving Adora over with a bright smile. Adora smiles as well before breaking into a light jog, pastries now a distant memory.

As soon as she's within earshot Catra begins detailing the dagger she picked up. "Adora, look at this one! It's exactly what I need." She holds up the poignard, its blackened blade pointing towards the sky as she grips the golden handle in her gloved hand. Suddenly she swings out her arm, flipping the dagger around in her palm and hitting a defensive stance, blade pointed out to the side. Adora remains unfazed- long used to Catra and her antics and well aware she is trying the blade out. The shopkeeper looks about an inch from their life.

Adora cackles as she reaches into her pocket for their shared coin purse, about to ask the owner for the price when suddenly she notices someone approaching out of the corner of her eye. It’s the same girl that was making googly eyes at Catra across the plaza, except she’s no longer across the plaza. She’s right there. Next to the stall. Next to them. Next to *Catra.*

Adora can feel her expression suddenly sour, re-vamped mood gone once again. Catra doesn’t notice though, looking at the stranger obviously within her wide range of personal space, eyebrow cocked and waiting for an explanation. Teenage Catra would’ve clawed this woman in the face for getting too close. A nasty part of Adora still wishes she would.

"I see you admire my work."

Adora crushes the coin purse in her fist.

…You've got to be joking.

Catra chuffs, rolling her eyes and stepping back. "It's decent work."

She wants to intervene. *By Etheria* does she want to step between them and push this hulking woman back, put her in her place and remind her that Catra is *taken,* just like she has been for the past four years. But she doesn't want to embarrass Catra. She doesn't like when people fight her own battles for her. It makes her feel weak. Adora never wants to be the one who makes her feel like that.

Amber hair leans on the shop stand, exploiting her newfound bravado now that she found an opportunity to talk to Catra. Catra tenses at the blatant gesture. Adora quickly places her palm on her lower back, letting her know she's there if she wants.

"You got something to say?" Catra quips.

The stranger huffs in amusement, standing back up and walking around the back of the stand. "Just introducing myself. Name's Lane. Been selling here a long time. Never seen you two around, though."

Adora noticed how her gaze switched to her on 'two'.

"Y'know," Catra said, tone conveying nothing but boredom. "Exploring new places with my girlfriend."

Adora feels a broad smirk appear on her face and a boastful sense of pride build in her chest as she watches the smug look on Lane's face drop. The other shopkeeper- probably a family member or other, clears their throat to break the thick layer of tension suddenly laying over the stall.

"One-forty for the poignard."

After completing their walk around the market square, they begin their trek back to where the ship is parked out in the Whispering Woods. What Catra said about exploring new places was true. They decided today would be a quick day trip for them, a nice break from castle life. Find a new place to explore, spend some time there and maybe travel somewhere else if they felt like it. It was something they did often nowadays now that they had the time. Adora is dutifully walking back towards the direction of their ship when she hears Catra huff out laughter behind her.

"What?" Adora asks, quickly turning to look over her shoulder. Maybe she's still high-strung from earlier, so what?

Catra's eyes gleam as she shoots her a sly smile. "Jealous much?"

Adora sputters, immediately stopping her storm through the woods and almost tripping over her own feet. "About what?" She squeaks out.

She chortles at Adora's response. Her face does that cute little scrunch that always happens when she laughs because she's just that effortlessly adorable.

"You're literally stomping through the woods, princess."

She bristles, immediately defensive that she's apparently so see-through now. "We're in the Whispering Woods, Cat. Who knows what's out here. We need to move quickly."

She hums in acknowledgment, gaze turned forward and looking past Adora's shoulder. "Did something change while we were shopping those last two hours where all the magic animals She-ra freed from a deep sleep now attack her again?" Her eyes fall back on her with a mischievous glint as she finishes her statement. Adora has no rebuttal and they both know it. So Catra continues. "Why does it bother you so much?"

And for some reason, that's all it takes for what little self-restraint Adora has left to snap like a twig. "Because!" She blurts out, throwing her arms up in the air in clear exasperation.

Catra stares at her blankly, waiting for her to continue, "Because…?"

"Because it's so obvious who we are! Literally, everyone on Etheria knows who we are, everyone knows we're together! Our relationship saved the world four years ago and everyone knows that!" Adora continues, pacing a path within the small trail space around them, silently mindful of any small flowers lingering about. "I know she knows that, and she still hit on you anyway, like I wasn't even there. I was right next to you, my hand was on your back for Etheria's sake! And on top of that she completely disrespected you- invaded your personal space with no warning and eyed you like you were some…some thing! She also-!"

Adora's rant is suddenly cut off by Catra's perfectly manicured hands on her cheeks, her lips crushing against hers in a sloppy and urgent kiss. She grunts, caught off guard as Catra physically tries to push herself deeper into the kiss. When she breaks away, they both breathe in a deep breath.

"I love you. So much, yeah?" She bites her lip as her eyes roam down Adora's face. "Also- you're like, *really* hot, Adora."

Adora is downright floored by her girlfriend's reaction. "Uh. I…I-I don't…"

Catra smiles, caressing her rose-kissed cheeks with the pads of her thumbs.

"You really love me, huh?"

Her gaze softens, looking down towards the shorter girl with absolute adoration in her eyes. "Of course I do. You don't deserve to be treated like that."

"She stood next to me, ‘Dora."

"But she-"

Catra quickly cuts her off, "Stop. I know what you're going to say- and I love you for it, but it's really okay. I can handle people like that."

Adora sighs, turning her face over to Catra's palm and breathing in her comforting scent. She knows that, she really does. And she knows the unspoken truth that lays behind her words, as well. *I've been through worse.*

“I know. I’m sorry,” she says.

Catra chuckles again, light and airy as she continues to stroke Adora’s cheeks with her thumbs. “You don’t need to apologize. It was honestly really sweet seeing how worked up it made you.”

Her steel blue eyes drift over Catra’s face as she speaks. She notices the small wrinkles around her eyes as she smiles, the cute

point of her nose, the dusty blush splayed across her sharp cheeks, and, oh- she just remembered what Catra said earlier. How could she miss that?

Adora feels one of her lopsided grins fall into place, suddenly feeling very cocky. “Just sweet?”

Her blush darkens as she simply shrugs, nonchalant and not breaking her smile for a second, playing it off as if she didn’t just call her hot during her outburst earlier.

"Oh, so you *didn't* call me hot before you kissed me out of the blue. Got it, got it," she sings. "For a second there it seemed like you were t-"

"Don't you dare."

"I won't, I won't," Adora says, backing away and holding up her hands in defeat, surrendering to Catra. "Let's get back to the ship." Adora grabs Catra's hand in hers, pulling her along as they start once again on the beaten-down path. Catra raises an eye towards her quizzically with the abrupt end to the conversation, but after a moment's silence, she ties her fingers with Adora's and continues next to her, forearms pressed side to side. It's when they reach the stairs of the ship that she takes the opportunity to speak again.

"Turned on."

"Ugh, 'Dora!" Her face grows beet red as she lunges at her, narrowly missing the blonde as she bolts up the steps in a fit of laughter. If they woke Melog from their nap as they tumbled into the bay on top of each other, they paid them no mind.

"...ra. 'Dora. Ahdorah."

Adora wakes with a start, suddenly rejuvenated with life as she felt her girlfriend insistently jostle her awake. She is plastered to her side, shaking her shoulder with extreme vitriol.

"Cat? What? What's wrong?" She sits up in a flurry, holding Catra tightly against her side to not throttle her around so much- and also keep her as close as possible.

"Relax, nothing is wrong I just…I feel like I'm gonna be sick. Everything's dizzy, can you… I can't-"

Adora quickly stands up, careening around the side of their bed back towards her girlfriend and reaching out for her again. Catra gladly takes her hands to stand up with her. She must really feel awful, Catra loathes asking for help. Adora will gladly assist her with whatever is asked at a moment's notice, but she knows it is a development from her lifelong struggle with power and independence. Adora has learned over time that being seen as weak is still one of her biggest insults, and it's not something that

can be changed just in a few years. Still, whatever Catra wants, Catra will get.

"How do you want to do this? Want me to carry you?" She asks as she nearly avoids barreling into Melog pawing at the bedroom door.

Catra shakes her head, eyes firmly squeezed shut. Adora can see how flushed her cheeks are. "No. Just walk with me, please?"

Adora hums an affirmative, placing a kiss against her temple in answer and curling her arm around her waist tighter.

Once they make it down the hall to the bathroom Catra barrels straight ahead for the disposal, folding over before Adora can fully open the door for her. She gives her the space for the time being- she's not leaving, she can yell at her later, and grabs one of her hair ties off of the shared bathroom counter. While she's still bent over the disposal Adora kneels behind her, slowly, and starts carding her fingers through her wild mane. She takes her time, gently scraping her scalp with her blunt nails while keeping the long strands out of her face. Once it is tied back in a loose bun, she breaks the silence. "Do you think it's morning sickness?"

Catra grunts, leaning back against the wall, eyes still shut. She must have a headache, too. "Definitely not. It's probably a fever or something. I'm sweating my ass off and I can't even open my damn eyes."

Adora hums, placing the back of her hand against her burning forehead. "What do you need? Ice? I'll bring you water. I don't think we brought any medication with us, though. Do you want me to go get some, I can go right now? Food, too. I could-"

"'Dora." She cuts off, a half smile sneaking through her pained complexion. "I think medicine and water will be fine."

"Right. Okay, medicine and water, I can do that. Do you want me to, uh…" she jerks out her hand, holding it upwards for Catra to take and help her up from the ground. She simply holds up her hand in response.

"I'm good."

Adora makes her way back into the square where they were shopping yesterday. Most of the shops are packed up and gone, a few still up and selling their goods, probably moving due to the close of the weekend. She distantly thinks about the pastries she left behind yesterday. She wonders if they're still open. Maybe Catra will like one of her curry puffs when she feels better.

As she walks further into the plaza, simultaneously scoping out the bakery and the apothecary, she notices the blacksmith stall from yesterday. Adora squints when she notices the same woman who got way too close to Catra. She feels that familiar fire in her chest strike match and the feeling quickly overwhelms her. She knows how capable Catra is to protect herself, but she's protective , okay? She can't help it. She loves her more than anything and she won't let some random woman disrespect her and everything

she's been through. And she *definitely* won't let this *Lane* girl even attempt to replace her without a fight. Said girl must notice Adora's, okay- *glare* because she sends Adora a downright agitating smirk. Before she can say or do anything the town's apothecary comes into view and she makes a direct line for the door, pretending she did not see Lane at all. She can try all she wants. Adora has twenty-six years over her.

The shopkeeper is a nice change of pace, however. They greet Adora warmly, a little too enthusiastic once they realize who she is, but she does her best to push it off as politely as possible. Once the shopkeeper accepts the non-formalities they tone it down and are receptive to the symptoms Adora lists off to her. Mostly.

"Oh my! Is she-"

"It's not that!" Adora cuts off abruptly, not liking the direction of that question and completely unwilling to discuss the facets of her and Catra's private life. The last thing Catra would want was all of Etheria discussing their sex life.

The shopkeeper tilts their head, perplexed by her quick answer. "Are you sure?"

"I- uh. She said it's not."

She furrows her brows. "Hmm."

"Look, I'm sorry. I don't mean to be rude, but we should get going soon. Do you have something for her symptoms?"

The shopkeeper brightens up again immediately, reaching underneath the counter for something. "Oh, of course! Regardless of the cause, this herbal remedy will help ebb her symptoms," she places a small round glass container with a wooden lid on the counter. "Efficient on Magicats and Etherians the like. Homemade, too. Just use it like you would your favorite tea."

After a quick exchange of currency and a parting goodbye, Adora heads back outside the shop, herbal remedy in hand. She has a small smile on her face from the simple fact that she knows Catra loves tea, and the first task to do when she gets back is to make her some. Said smile only lasts until she opens the door to the shop and her number one enemy is stationed outside, waiting for her with the most excruciatingly smug look on her face.

"Care to spar?"

Her gaze darkens, shooting the blacksmith the most menacing look she can muster up. She feels that familiar fire coil up in her chest again. “Why are you so insistent on ruining my day?” She shoots.

Lane throws her head back to bark out a laugh at Adora, which only infuriates her more. What is this woman’s problem?

"Ruin your day? C'mon blondie, I'm just trying to have some fun! Who doesn't want to spar with the ` *The Mighty She-ra',"* she laughs like she is making some kind of joke. A horrible one, anyway. Something about that sentence only adds fire to her flame. The way she said it like she was undermining her ability as She-ra, something she was proud to say she'd become confident in. Or more likely it was because this awful woman just openly admitted she was vying for someone she *knew* she was dating, who was dating *someone* - her's or not, and was outright challenging her in some sick sort of powerplay. Adora growled, spinning around on her heels.

She walks right up to Lane and aggressively points a finger in her face. "*Don't* call me that."

Lane simply makes a dismissive sound and grunts. Her bulky arms are crossed, keeping up her stance. Adora's brows furrow, even more, daring her to say something else. Instead, she says nothing, just stares at Adora with that smirk she's grown oh-so-tired of. Adora's sick of this. She's sick of this woman. She should be on her ship, tending to her very ill girlfriend after she woke up miserable and spent her morning in the bathroom, but instead, she's here- facing the same woman from yesterday who decided to make ruining their weekend her personal game and disrespect Catra right in front of her. Adora doesn't need to deal with this, and neither does Catra. She should be with her, tending to her every need like she deserves and not giving her attention to those who don't deserve it at all. She scoffs, turning her back to Lane and putting special care to the way her hair flips in her face as she walks away from her once again, and hopefully for the last time.

But she makes it three steps before she opens her mouth again.

"Give a good farewell to that kitten for me, hm?"

And that's all she needs for the soles of her feet to hit the dirt and propel her around once again. The air around them suddenly becomes charged with magic as her vision whites out and blind, pure fury erupts out of her. That fire that had dug out its home in her chest yesterday has finally crescendoed, supercharged, and put all its begrudged fury in her fist as it collides with Lane's chin. Herbal what's-it gone flying somewhere in the air. She can insult She-ra. She can insult the way that she fights, the way she looks, or the way she simply *is* , and she just doesn't care. But she draws the line at Catra. She will always draw the line at disrespecting Catra.

--

Catra is sitting up in bed scratching behind Melog's ears where they lay beside her on the bed, scrolling through her and Adora's shared tracker pad at the correspondence letters Glimmer sent her to look over. Her headache is gone for the time being but the queasy feeling remains in her stomach, as well as the mild sweat gathering on her forehead. She tries to pay it no mind, willing it to go away as if it would wither without attention. Melog perks up next to her suddenly, staring at the door to their room, ears pinned forward and waiting expectantly. Catra feels her heart do a little flip in her chest, waiting for her lover to bound through the door.

A moment passes before Adora does. She doesn't bound in like she usually does. She sort of struts in with her shoulders hunched. Ashamed, maybe? And she's holding a cup of something steaming in her hands. Catra quirks her eyebrow in question, following her movements as she draws closer to the bed and gingerly places the cup in her open palms. She sits down next to Catra on the side of the bed she's on and reaches up to place the back of her hand against her forehead. "Can't you ever take a break from work?"

She hums, taking a small sip of the tea Adora had brought her. It definitely tastes a bit medicinal. "Look who's talking."

Adora smiles before leaning in and placing a ginger kiss on her forehead. "By the way, we're banned from Sylvan."

Catra sputters into her cup, choking on the tea as hot liquid flies out. Melog jumps out of the way next to her. Adora's hand's bolt out to catch the cup from falling out of her hands, looking at her with utter confusion as if she didn't just drop a completely offhanded statement. "What?! What did you do!"

Now it was Adora's turn to sputter. "Nothing!" Her gaze quickly darted to the side. "She challenged me!"

Catra's ears fall as she grimaces. "Adora…"

"No- wait, I really did try to stay away from her, I promise. But she kept following me and pestering me. She challenged me to a fight as some sort of powerplay! And she just…Ugh! She got under my skin, Catra."

Catra sighed, pinching the bridge of her nose as she listened. Adora has always had a problem controlling her anger since they were young. Both of them, honestly. But Adora has gotten significantly better at it over time. They've both learned that while a great deal of Etheria may respect and love She-ra, that never means *all.*

"Okay," She finally says. She breathes out. "What did she say?"

Adora's eyes widen, mouth falling agape. "She…uh…called you kitten. And…told me to give you a good farewell," her eyes fall on her, awaiting her reaction. Catra only stares back blankly.

"Did you win?"

Adora's sure-felt signature smile breaks through, the one she has whenever she's feeling extra bold or cocky. She loves that smile. "You know I did. She wanted to fight She-ra so bad I decided to give her a chance. Didn't do too well, obviously."

"Oh, Adora," Catra groans, pressing her hand against her mouth to try and stifle the laugh that still seeped through.

"Hey, she'll be fine. She kinda deserved it."

Catra smiles warmly, cupping both hands around Adora's cheeks to pull her down closer to her on the bed. "Yeah, she did."

Alternative AU

Chapter Summary

> Alternate version of original fic. Anything to do with p word implications in the original have been removed and edited for more to enjoy.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

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At least, she considers herself someone who's trying to be a reasonable person. Because right now this might just be one of the most difficult challenges she's faced, and she's had her fair share of those. Egocentric warlords, abusive mother figures, losing the people closest to her (repeatedly), an even bigger galactic warlord- she's fought that and won. But some girl eyeing Catra right across from her in a busy market?

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And she doesn't know how to handle that.

The girl in question, undoubtedly, is pretty. And that might just be what adds to the fire building in her chest. She's bulkier than Adora, around a foot taller and with arms twice the size of hers and she's looking at Catra across the plaza with an enamored look on her face while she twirls her long amber hair around her fingers. Adora knows Catra. She knows what she likes. Adora can’t say Catra hasn’t had her fair share of unwarranted suitors throughout her life, she knows that’s not true- because look at her. It’s just that no one has been so bold as to do it in front of her.

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Breathe.

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Lane. Been selling here a long time, never seen you two around, though."

Adora noticed how her gaze switched to her on 'two'.

"Y'know," Catra said, tone nothing but bored. "Exploring new places with my girlfriend."

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And that's all it takes for what little self-restraint Adora has left to snap like a twig. "Because!" She blurts out, throwing her arms up in the air in clear exasperation.

Catra stares at her blankly, waiting for her to continue, "Because…?"

"Because it's so obvious who we are! Literally, everyone on Etheria knows who we are, everyone knows we're together! Our relationship saved the world four years ago and everyone knows that!" Adora continues, pacing a path within the small trail space around them, silently mindful of any small flowers lingering about. "I know she knows that, and she still hit on you anyway, like I wasn't even there. I was right next to you, my hand was on your back for Etheria's sake! And on top of that she completely disrespected you- invaded your personal space with no warning and eyed you like you were some…thing! She also-!"

Adora's rant is suddenly cut off by Catra's perfectly manicured hands on her cheeks and her lips crushing against hers in a sloppy and urgent kiss. She grunts, caught off guard as Catra physically tries to push herself deeper into the kiss. When she breaks away, they both breathe in a deep breath.

"I love you. So much, yeah?" She bites her lip as her eyes roam down Adora's face. "Also- you're like, really hot, Adora."

Adora is downright floored by her girlfriend's reaction. "Uh. I…I- I don't…"

Catra smiles, caressing her rose-kissed cheeks with the pads of her thumbs.

"You really love me, huh?"

Her gaze softens, looking down towards the shorter girl with absolute adoration in her eyes. "Of course I do. You don't deserve to be treated like that."

"She stood next to me, `Dora."

"But she-"

Catra quickly cuts her off, "Stop. I know what you're going to say- and I love you for it, but it's really okay. I can handle people like that."

Adora sighs, turning her face over to Catra's palm and breathing in her comforting scent. She knows that, she really does. And she knows the unspoken truth behind her words, as well. I've been through worse.

"I know. I'm sorry," she says.

Catra chuckles again, light and airy as she continues to stroke Adora's cheeks with her thumbs. "You don't need to apologize. It was honestly really sweet seeing how worked up it made you."

Her steel blue eyes drift over Catra's face as she speaks. She notices the small wrinkles around her eyes as she smiles, the cute point of her nose, the dusty blush splayed across her sharp cheeks, and, oh- she just remembered what Catra said earlier. How could she miss that?

Adora feels one of her lopsided grins fall into place, suddenly feeling very cocky. “Just sweet?”

Her blush darkens as she simply shrugs, nonchalant and not breaking her smile for a second, playing it off as if she didn’t just call her hot during her outburst earlier.

"Oh, so you didn't call me hot when you kissed me out of the blue. Got it, got it," she sings. "For a second there it seemed like you were t-"

"Don't you dare."

"I won't, I won't," Adora said, backing away and holding up her hands in defeat, surrendering to Catra. "Let's get back to the ship." Adora grabbed Catra's hand in hers, pulling her along as they started once again on the beaten-down path. Catra raised an eye towards her quizzically with the abrupt end to the conversation, but after a moment's silence, she tied her fingers with Adora and continues next to her, forearms pressed side to side. It was when they reached the stairs of the ship that she took the opportunity to speak again.

"Turned on."

"Ugh, 'Dora!" Her face grew beet red as she lunged at her, narrowly missing the blonde as she bolted up the steps in a fit of laughter. If they woke Melog from their nap as they tumbled into the bay on top of each other, they paid them no mind.

"...ra. 'Dora. Ahdorah."

Adora woke with a start, suddenly rejuvenated with life as she felt her girlfriend insistently shake her awake. She was plastered to her side, shaking her shoulder with extreme vitriol.

"Cat? What? What's wrong?" She sat up in a flurry, holding Catra tightly against her side to not throttle her around so much- and also keep her as close as possible.

"Relax, nothing is wrong I just…I feel like I'm gonna be sick. Everything's dizzy, can you… I can't-"

Adora quickly stands up, careening around the side of the bed back towards her girlfriend and reaching out for her again. Catra gladly takes her hands to stand up with her. She must really feel awful, Catra hates asking for help. Adora will gladly assist her with whatever is asked at a moment's notice, but she knows it is a development from her lifelong struggle with power and independence. Adora has learned over time that being seen as 'weak' is still one of her biggest insults, and it's not something that can be changed just in a few years. Still, whatever Catra wants, Catra gets.

"How do you want to do this? Want me to carry you?" She asks as she nearly avoids barreling into Melog pawing at the bedroom door.

Catra shakes her head, eyes squeezed shut. Adora can see how flushed her cheeks are. "No. Just walk with me, please?"

Adora hums, placing a kiss against her temple in answer and curling her arm around her waist tighter.

Once they make it down the hall to the bathroom Catra barrels straight ahead for the disposal, folding over before Adora can fully open the door for her. She gives her the space- she's not leaving, she can yell at her later, and grabs one of her hair ties off of the shared bathroom counter. While she's still bent over the disposal Adora kneels behind her, slowly, and starts carding her fingers through her wild mane. She takes her time, gently scraping her scalp with her blunt nails while keeping the long strands out of her face. Once it is tied back in a loose bun, she breaks the silence. "You think it's something you ate?"

Catra grunts, leaning back against the wall, eyes still shut. She must have a headache, too. "Definitely not. It's probably a fever or something. I'm sweating my ass off and I can't even open my damn eyes."

Adora hums, placing the back of her hand against her burning forehead. "What do you need? Ice? I'll bring you water. I don't think we brought any medication with us, though. Do you want me to go get some? I could go right now if you need me to. Shit, food, too. I could-"

"'Dora." She cuts off, a half smile sneaking through her pained complexion. "I think medicine and water will be fine."

"Right. Okay, medicine and water, I can do that. Do you want me to, uh…" she jerks out her hand, holding it upwards for Catra to take and help her up from the ground. She simply holds up her hand in response.

"I'm good."

Adora makes her way back into the square where they were shopping yesterday. Most of the shops were packed up and gone, a few still up and selling their goods, probably moving due to the close of the weekend. She distantly thinks about the pastries she left behind yesterday. She wonders if they're still open. Maybe Catra will like one of her curry puffs when she feels better.

As she walks farther into the plaza, simultaneously scoping out the bakery and the apothecary, she notices the blacksmith stall from yesterday. Adora squints her eyes when she notices the same woman who got way too close to Catra. She feels that familiar fire in her chest strike match and the feeling overwhelms her. She knows how capable Catra is to defend herself, but she's protective, okay? She can't help it. She loves her more than anything and she won't let some random woman disrespect her and everything she's been through. And she definitely won't let this Lane girl even attempt to replace her without a fight. Said girl must notice Adora's, okay- glare because she sends Adora a downright agitating smirk. Before she can say or do anything the town's apothecary comes into view and she makes a direct line for the door, pretending she did not see Lane at all. She can try all she wants. Adora has twenty-six years over her.

The shopkeeper is a nice change of pace, however. They greet Adora warmly, a little too enthusiastic once they realize who she is, but she does her best to push it off as politely as possible. Once the shopkeeper accepts the non-formalities they tone it down and are receptive to the symptoms Adora lists off to her. Mostly.

"Oh my! Is she well? My goodness, if she-"

"It's not that!" Adora cuts off abruptly, not liking the direction of that question and completely unwilling to discuss the possibilities of Catra ever being that sick. The last thing Catra would want was all of Etheria discussing a bleak rumor like that.

The shopkeeper shys away, looking somewhat embarrassed by her quick answer. “My apologies, She-ra. I may have gotten a little… carried away there. "

Adora grimaces awkwardly at her to placate her nerves. "Look, it's okay, really. And I'm sorry, I don't mean to be rude, but we really need get going soon. Do you have something for her symptoms?"

The shopkeeper brightens up again immediately, reaching underneath the counter for something. "Oh, of course! Regardless of the cause, this herbal remedy will help ebb her symptoms," she places a small round glass container with a wooden lid on the counter. "Efficient on Magicats and Etherians the like. Homemade, too. Just use it like you would your favorite tea."

After a quick exchange of currency and a parting goodbye, Adora heads back outside the shop, herbal remedy in hand. She has a small smile on her face from the simple fact that she knows Catra loves tea, and the first task to do when she gets back is to make her some. That is until she opens the door to the shop and her number one enemy is stationed outside, waiting for her with the most excruciatingly smug look on her face.

"Care to spar?"

Her gaze darkens, shooting the blacksmith the most menacing look she can muster up. She feels that familiar fire coil up in her chest again. “Why are you so insistent on ruining my day?” She quips.

Lane throws her head back to bark out a laugh at Adora, which only infuriates her more. What is this woman’s problem?

“Ruin your day? C’mon blondie, I’m just trying to have some fun! Who doesn’t want to spar with the ‘The Mighty She-ra’,” she laughed like she was making some kind of joke. A horrible one. Something about that sentence only added fire to her flame. The way she said it like she was undermining her ability as She-ra, something she was proud to say she’d become confident in. Or maybe it was because this awful woman just openly admitted she was vying for someone she knew she was dating, who was dating someone- her’s or not, and was outright challenging her in some sick sort of powerplay. Adora growled, spinning around on her heels.

She walked right up to Lane and aggressively pointed a finger in her face. “Don’t call me that.”

Lane simply made a dismissive sound and grunted. Her bulky arms were crossed, keeping up her stance. Adora’s brows furrow, even more, daring her to say something else. Instead, she says nothing, just stares at Adora with that smirk she’s grown oh-so-tired of. Adora’s sick of this. She’s sick of this woman. She should be on her ship, tending to her very ill girlfriend after she woke up miserable and spent her morning in the bathroom, but instead, she’s here- facing the same woman from yesterday who decided to make ruining their weekend her personal game and disrespect Catra in front of her. Adora doesn’t need to deal with this, and neither does Catra. She should be with her, tending to her every need right now like she deserves and not giving her attention to those who don’t deserve it at all. She scoffs, turning her back to Lane and putting special attention to the way her hair flips in her face as she walks away from her once again, and hopefully for the last time.

But she makes it three steps before she opens her mouth again.

“Give a good farewell to that kitten for me, hm?”

And that’s all she needs for the soles of her feet to hit the dirt and propel her around once again. The air around them suddenly becomes charged with magic as her vision whites out and blind, pure fury erupts out of her. That fire that had made its home in her chest yesterday has finally crescendoed, supercharged, and putting all its begrudged fury in her fist as it collides with Lane’s chin, herbal what’s-it gone flying somewhere in the air. She can insult She-ra. She can insult the way that she fights, the way she looks, or the way she simply is, and she just doesn’t care. But she draws the line at Catra. She will always draw the line at disrespecting Catra.

--

Catra is sitting up in bed scratching behind Melog’s ears where they lay beside her on the bed, scrolling through her and Adora’s shared tracker pad at the correspondence letters Glimmer sent her to look over. Her headache is gone for the time being but the queasy feeling remains in her stomach, as well as the mild sweat gathering on her forehead. She tries to pay it no mind, willing it to go away as if it would wither without attention. Melog perks up next to her suddenly, staring at the door to their room, ears pinned forward and waiting expectantly. Catra feels her heart do a little flip in her chest, waiting for her lover to bound through the door.

A moment passes before Adora does. Except she doesn’t bound in like she usually does. She sort of struts in with her shoulders hunched. Ashamed, maybe? And she’s holding a cup of something steaming in her hands. Catra quirks her eyebrow in question, following her movements as she draws closer to the bed and gingerly places the cup in her open palms. She sits down next to Catra on the side of the bed she’s on and reaches up to place the back of her against her forehead. “Can’t you ever take a break from work?”

She hums, taking a small sip of the tea Adora had brought her. It definitely smells a bit medicinal. “Look who’s talking.”

Adora smiles before leaning in and placing a ginger kiss on her forehead. “By the way, we’re banned from Sylvan.”

Catra sputters into her cup, choking on the tea as hot liquid flies out. Melog jumps out of the way next to her. Adora’s hand’s bolt out to catch the cup from falling from her hands, looking at her with utter confusion as if she didn’t just drop a completely offhanded statement on her. “What?! What did you do!”

Now it was Adora’s turn to sputter. “Nothing!” Her gaze quickly darted to the side. “She challenged me!”

Catra’s ears fall as she grimaces. “Adora…”

“No- wait, I really did try to stay away from her, I promise. But she kept following me and pestering me. She challenged me to a fight as some sort of powerplay! And she just…Ugh! She got under my skin, Catra.”

Catra sighed, pinching the bridge of her nose as she listened. Adora has always had a problem controlling her anger since they were young. Both of them, honestly. But Adora has gotten significantly better at it over time. They’ve both learned that while a great deal of Etheria may respect and love She-ra, that never means all.

“Okay,” She finally says. She breathes out. “What did she say?”

Adora’s eyes widened, mouth falling agape. “She…uh…called you kitten. And…told me to give you a good farewell,” her eyes fall on her, awaiting her reaction. Catra only stares blankly.

“Did you win?”

Adora’s signature smile breaks through, the one she has whenever she’s feeling extra bold or cocky. She loves that smile. “You know

I did. She wanted to fight She-ra so bad I decided to give her the chance. Didn't do too well, obviously."

"Oh, Adora," Catra pressed her hand against her mouth, trying to stifle the laugh that still seeped through.

"Hey, she'll be fine. She totally deserved it."

Catra smiled warmly, cupping both hands on Adora's cheeks to pull her down closer to her on the bed. "Yeah, she did."

Chapter End Notes

@cayatelynn on twit

End Notes

This was also my longest fic yet, I debated getting a beta, but, whatever right
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